Hello,

Thank you for asking for clarification. I want to explain this very simply and practically.

This document is provided for **clarification only** and does **not** introduce any new requirements, features, or changes beyond what was already defined in the previously submitted "final" specification.

The concepts of **Spotlight (Primary)** and **Sparks (Matches)** were already defined in the main spec. This document expands on that explanation in simpler, more practical terms to ensure shared understanding and correct implementation.

During review, we also identified that at some point the system behavior and dashboard representation shifted from a **role-based model** (Primary matched with multiple Matches) to a **slot-based model** using generic positions such as *Participant 1–4*. This was not an intended design change and does not align with how PodLove functions.

As a result, this document serves two purposes:

1. To **re-clarify the intended Spotlight/Spark role model** that already exists in the spec.
2. To **confirm that the system must return to a role-based implementation**, where the Spotlight (Primary) and Sparks (Matches) are explicitly defined and used by system logic, rather than inferred from participant position.

The attached screenshots are included to illustrate the observed regression and provide visual context. **No new functionality is being requested**; this is a clarification and correction to ensure the system behaves as originally specified.

Spark and Spotlight are not user types. They are temporary roles assigned per episode. Any user (any gender) can be either role at different times.

Here is how the system works in real terms:

1. Spotlight

- The Spotlight (Primary) is the *one person featured in Episode 1*.
- This person is meeting multiple people in that episode.
- The number of people they meet (2, 3, or 4, are the Sparks (Matches)) during the episode depends on the Spotlight's plan.
- All users appear together in Episode 1.
- The Spotlight:
    - Appears in Episode 1
    - Chooses one Spark at the end of Episode 1
    - Schedules Episode 2 with that chosen Spark
    - Is the "primary decision-maker" for that episode only

2. Sparks

- Sparks/matches are the people matched *to the Spotlight for that episode*.
- They are not matched to each other.
- Each Spark:
  - Appears in Episode 1
  - Does NOT choose anyone
  - May or may not be chosen by the Spotlight
- Only **one Spark** is chosen to continue to Episode 2.

3. What happens after Episode 1

- The Spotlight chooses **one Spark**.
- Only the Spotlight + chosen Spark:
  - Get chat access
  - Schedule Episode 2
  - Continue in the system together
  - Receive post-date and Episode 2 surveys
- All other Sparks exit that episode's flow and are **returned to the dating pool.**

4. Important implementation detail

- **The system must understand these roles at the logic level, not by position**.
- The system must always know **which user is the Spotlight and which users are Sparks**.
- This must be stored explicitly (as a role or flag), not inferred from position (Participant 1, 2, 3, etc.).
- All logic (chat access, scheduling, surveys, AI learning) must reference the role, not the slot order.
- The Spotlight must always be treated differently than Sparks in:
  - Scheduling
  - Chat access
  - Surveys
  - Episode progression
- Sparks are peers to each other, but not equal to the Spotlight in the flow.

5. Very simple example

- Episode 1 has:
  - 1 Spotlight
  - 2, 3, or 4 Sparks (depending on the Spotlight's plan)
- Episode 2 always has:
  - 1 Spotlight
  - 1 Spark (the one selected)

That's it. No more, no less.

Please confirm that:

- Spark and Spotlight are treated as **roles**, not user types
- These roles drive system behavior (not UI position or order)
- Any user can be either role in different episodes

Once we are aligned on this, everything else (dashboard, scheduling, surveys) will behave correctly.

Thank you.